SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

A TRACER STUDY OF BSED GRADUATES OF SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA BATCH 2020-2024

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Teacher Education

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF PHYSICAL EDUCATION

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MARCH 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

		Pages
TITLE PAGE		i
CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL		ii
ABSTRACT		iii
DEDICATION		iv
ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS		v
TABLE OF CONTENTS		vi
LIST OF TABLES		viii
LIST OF FIGURES		x
CHAPTER		
1	**THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE**	1
	1.1 Background of the study	1
	1.2 Review of Related Literature	4
	1.3 Theoretical and Conceptual Framework	34
	1.4 Schematic Diagram	35
	1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study	36
	1.6 Scope and Limitations	37
	1.7 Hypothesis	
	1.8 Definition of Terms	37
2	**RESEARCH METHODOLOGY**	42
	2.1 Research Design	42
	2.2 Research Materials and Methods	10
	2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample	12
	2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan	13
	2.5 Research Ethical Standards	14
3	**RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS**	19
	3.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data	19
	3.2 Proposed Intervention/ Output	19
4	**SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS**	44
	4.1 Summary	45
	4.2 Conclusion	46
	4.3 Recommendations	47
REFERENCES		50
CURRICULUM VITAE		59
APPENDICES		
CERTIFICATE OF TECHNOLOGY BASED ASSESSMENT		68
PUBLISHABLE JOURNAL		100

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
College Of Teacher Education

CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **"A TRACER STUDY OF BSED ALUMNI GRADUATES OF SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA BATCH 2020-2024"** presented and submitted by **Fideles J., Almasa C., Bation J., Landao C., Moral J., Napone E., Truza C.,** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **Bachelor of Physical Education** is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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ABSTRACT

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III. FINDINGS

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IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

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1.**Opening Statement**
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3.**Closing (Optional)**
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Opening Statement
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Acknowledgment of Advisors and Professors
• Thank your thesis advisor, committee members, or professors for their guidance and expertise.

Acknowledgment of Family and Friends
•Thank those who provided emotional or financial support.

Acknowledgment of Institutional or Financial Support
•Recognize scholarships, grants, or organizations that funded or facilitated your research.

Special Thanks (Optional)
Mention individuals who provided significant help, such as peers, mentors, or technical staff.

Closing Statement
•Conclude with a general expression of gratitude.

Example

I am deeply grateful to everyone who contributed to the completion of this thesis. My sincerest thanks to my advisor, Dr. [Name], for your invaluable insights and guidance. To my committee members, thank you for your constructive feedback and support.

To my family, your love and encouragement kept me going through this journey, and to my friends, your support meant the world to me. I would also like to thank [Institution/Organization] for funding this research.

Special thanks to [Name], for your assistance in [specific task]. To everyone who helped in any way, thank you for making this possible.



LIST OF TABLES

Table	Pages
1	
2	
3	

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

The goal of higher education is to produce graduates who can become entrepreneurs, secure jobs, and contribute to their communities, society, and the country with their hard work and innovative ideas (Ead et al., 2023). In this way, higher education has a significant role in preparing graduates to be employment-ready (Srivastava et al., 2022). Therefore, in southern Africa, a tracer study was conducted to determine the employment status and the value of the program for graduates from the first group of Postgraduate Distance Education Alumni at the University of Zambia (Manchishi et al., 2020). As one of the requirements at the HEIs in Cambodia, CHET Chealy, (2021) conducted research to understand graduates' employability and how satisfied they are with the curriculum, while Basir et al. (2022) conducted a tracer study to map graduates' soft skills, their job status after graduation, and to understand how these skills affect employability.

In the Philippines, many tracer studies have been conducted to examine the career paths of graduates (Abana et al., 2021; Bacani et al., 2023; Bansiong et al., 2020; Caingcoy et al., 2021; Calamayo, 2022) and to collect employability data across various fields of specialization. Every skill taught by the universities is invaluable for graduates' jobs (Palao et al., 2022), and obtaining a master's degree enhances job prospects, career advancement, and personal growth (Garcia et al., 2024). Francisco & Aquino (2024) found that passing the licensure examination for a professional teacher increases employment chances, and the assessments included in their teacher education curriculum are highly relevant to their jobs. However, they recommended using larger sample sizes in future studies to understand the robustness and generalizability of the findings. Likewise, Tayco et al. (2022) found that the curriculum and skills learned in college were instrumental in their jobs.

It identifies essential skills such as critical thinking, problem solving, communication, and human relations. Still, it is recommended to do a similar study in a different setting to validate the result.

Employability skills are essential for graduates to prepare for the job market, secure and maintain employment (Mat Sakam et al., 2022; Ulanday, 2021). Fajaryati et al. (2020) state that individuals will have a better chance of securing a job if they possess a good education and training, strong skills, and the ability to work well with others, effectively utilize technology, solve problems, and have good communication skills. Hence, it is crucial to equip young people with essential employability skills. These skills include basic skills, thinking skills, personal quality skills, resource and capability skills, interpersonal skills, information skills, and system technology skills (Holidi & Seman, 2023).

In the Caraga Region, Saint Michael College of Caraga is a competitive institution that offers a range of programs. For Teacher Education, it offers majors including Physical Education, BTVTED, English, Science, Social Studies, and Mathematics. Under the guidelines of the Philippine Association of Colleges and Universities Commission on Accreditation (PACUCOA), the school is required to conduct a tracer study to assess the employability of its graduates, the skills they gained that are useful in their jobs, and evaluate whether the curriculum matches the needs of the job market. Cacho et al. (2022) state that identifying graduates' employability is essential to the field of educational research. This is essential to higher education accreditation because the process requires information on graduates' first employment, the extent to which their job aligns with their field of expertise, and their initial job title (Haq et al., 2020). Every higher education institution in the Philippines is required by the Commission on Higher Education to conduct a tracer study, which is also one of the documents that any higher education accrediting organization requires (Daminar et al., 2022; Meto, 2023).

Therefore, this study aims to conduct a tracer study on Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates, addressing the gaps above. This study aims to trace graduates' employment status and the employability skills acquired in college that have been found helpful in their current jobs. This study will also provide essential insights into the College of Teacher Education and the professional trajectories of its graduates, helping institutions assess how effectively the teacher education program prepares future teachers with the necessary skills, knowledge, and competencies. This study will serve as an accountability mechanism by indicating to stakeholders how effectively the BSEd program at Saint Michael College of Caraga develops qualified, reflective, and committed secondary teachers who can create engaging learning opportunities for high school students.

The graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga who finished a Bachelor of Secondary Education (BSEd) with majors in Technical-Vocational Teacher Education, Physical Education, English, and Science will be the respondents of this study. The study aims to determine whether these graduates are employed and if their jobs are related to their profession, allowing us to evaluate the program's relevance and efficacy in preparing students for their careers. This study also aims to determine whether graduates are pursuing lifelong learning activities and the micro-credentials they have attained. Specifically, this study will seek to examine the Eligibility, highest educational attainment, monthly income, nature of work, place of work, employment status, and employable skills acquired in college, such as basic skills, thinking skills, personal quality skills, resource and capability skills, interpersonal skills, information skills, and system technological skills.

This study will benefit the institution, notably the College of Teacher Education Department, by providing valuable and reliable data on the career outcomes of BSEd graduates majoring in Technical-Vocational Teacher Education, Physical Education, English, and Sciences from

the 2020–2024 batch. The findings of this study may also help the administration to assess the effectiveness of the College of Teacher Education Department in preparing the graduates to become globally competitive, meet the demands of the workforce, enabling curriculum enhancements and teaching methodologies on analyzing graduates' experiences in the workforce, including their professional development and contributions to the educational community. Furthermore, this study will also be beneficial for parents and students in choosing schools and degree programs. For preservice teachers, it will also provide an understanding of the issues and real-world experiences of graduates, inspiring them to enhance their academic preparation, take advantage of additional learning opportunities, and work harder to secure employment in the future.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

Among all college graduate programs, teacher education is a crucial field because it prepares individuals for various professions. Mangiduyos & Subia (2021) state that the primary goal of teacher education institutes is to produce skilled and certified graduates who can work in the Philippines and abroad. Phuong et al. (2023) state that before graduation, graduates undertake an industrial practicum. This practicum is an excellent opportunity for employers to assess the readiness of college students for real-world work by observing their performance on the job. Therefore, graduates are expected to possess a range of employability skills to become successful employees in real-world settings.

To determine whether the goal is achieved, a tracer study is an appropriate tool for assessing the employability of graduates (Cacho et al., 2022). O. Odede et al. (2021) and A. Sensal et al. (2023) state that tracer studies are a valuable tool as they provide the correct and reliable feedback on how institutions provide quality education and services to their students. However,

the 21st century has dramatically changed how people work and the way workplaces operate. Tushar & Sooraksa (2023) conclude that the global challenges will affect emerging economies. As many people enter the workforce, job opportunities may decrease. Therefore, students and recent graduates must equip themselves with the necessary skills and competencies, in addition to their degrees, to succeed in a competitive job market. They must possess the right skills and capabilities to meet employers' expectations and adjust to changes in the job market (Hosain et al., 2023). To achieve this, schools and universities must adapt to these changes to meet global market expectations and produce high-quality graduates.

Moreover, employability is broadly defined as a person's ability to secure and sustain a job by possessing a set of personal qualities, job-specific, transferable skills, and knowledge that employers consider essential for good performance at work (Tight, 2023). Employability is seen as a key factor in employment outcomes, and as an ongoing process of lifelong learning, development, and career management to gain, maintain, and progress in the workplace and navigate the labor market across individuals' employment lifetimes (Cook, 2022; Healy et al., 2022; Masduki et al., 2022).

Bachelor of Secondary Education (BSEd)

The Bachelor of Secondary Education Majoring in Technical-Vocational Teacher Education, Physical Education, English, and Sciences is a four-year degree program designed to equip future teachers to teach at the secondary level. However, the Commission on Higher Education emphasized that the Bachelor of Secondary Education degree program is a major in English, Filipino, Mathematics, Sciences, Social Studies, and Values Education. The Bachelor of Technical-Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) program and the Bachelor of Physical Education (BPEd) are

not part of the Bachelor of Secondary Education. They are separate programs under the CHED memorandum, but they are still recognized as degree programs.

In the study by Moreno et al. (2025), it is stated that the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) introduced the Bachelor's in Technical-Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) program through CMO Nos. 78 and 79, Series of 2017, as part of a new technical vocational education initiative. The goal of this four-year teacher education program is to develop skilled and motivated educators who focus on technology and livelihood education by teaching future teachers the necessary technical and vocational skills. The BTVTEd curriculum has been updated to correspond with the K to 12 Curriculum. It follows the Philippine Professional Standards for Teachers, based on the latest version of the National Competency-Based Teacher Standards (NCBTS) (J. M. A. Alinea & Alinea, 2020).

The goal is to address the country's need for trainers in technical and vocational schools by offering high-quality technical teacher education. Fiel et al. (2024), cited by Maricris (2022), mentioned that graduates of the program are expected to become skilled educators who can guide students to reach their full potential and encourage lifelong learning. They should also be able to organize and present knowledge effectively, fostering critical and analytical thinking among students. Therefore, graduates must have technical and teaching skills that meet industry needs to succeed in teaching and work environments. This approach ensures that the education provided is current and can adapt to the changing needs of the job market (J. M. L. Alinea, 2021).

Similarly, Lobo (2022) emphasized that Physical Education is a new program offered by a local college. Initially, the Bachelor of Physical Education major in School Physical Education (BPE-SPE) was established based on CMO No. 23, Series of 2011. It was later changed to the Bachelor of Physical Education (BPEd) according to CMO No. 80, Series of 2017. The BPEd is a four-year

program designed to equip graduates with the essential skills to meet the physical, mental, and emotional needs of students. Physical Education is an integral part of the education system, focusing on the overall development of a person's physical, mental, social, emotional, and even spiritual well-being through carefully chosen physical activities.

Physical Education is essential in education because students should learn not only concepts and theories but also physical activities that help them stay mentally and physically fit. Additionally, the College enhanced the BPEd curriculum with assistance from the academic committee, ensuring that all teacher education students are better equipped with the knowledge and skills they need for their future careers as teachers, other job opportunities, and licensure exams.

Although the study by Sano et al. (2024) found that graduates of the Bachelor of Physical Education can get jobs and succeed in their careers, with most of them working in their field of expertise, this finding shows the program's effectiveness in preparing them for the workforce. The students are trained to meet the demand of the job market. However, some studies suggest that physical education graduates have a low employability rate and that the curriculum needs improvement.

According to Carag (2020)**,** only a few graduates have secured professional teaching jobs, despite the college's goal of producing skilled teachers through its Music, Arts, Physical Education, and Health program. This situation suggests that the curriculum needs to be reviewed and improved, including enhanced faculty development, teaching methods, licensure exam preparation, admission and retention policies, and student research. Similarly, Berja (2021) found that graduates are slightly satisfied with the knowledge and skills they gained from the program.

Therefore, it is recommended that the Bachelor of Physical Education curriculum be enhanced to ensure graduates possess the skills needed to remain competitive in the industry.

Moreover, the Bachelor of Secondary Education majoring in Science (BSEd-Science) and English have been studied to evaluate student satisfaction and the employability of graduates from these programs. Mehdaoui (2022) examined the employability skills of English majors. Many Algerians believe that being fluent in English can help them get better jobs, as English is increasingly essential in today's job market. Graduates with an English major succeed in a variety of fields, including teaching, librarianship, management, sales, marketing, and all of which require advanced and technical English skills. Patalinghug et al. (2025) state that the increasing demand for skilled English teachers has led many students to pursue the Bachelor of Secondary Education (BSED) program, with a focus on English. The global demand for English teachers has led to an increasing number of students opting for English-related programs and seeking opportunities abroad to teach English (ALTAAİ & GOKGOZ-KURT, 2023).

For the Bachelor of Secondary Education Major in Science, Basagre (2024) found that the first graduates of a new BSEd Science program at a Philippine state university were mainly satisfied with the curriculum, teaching, facilities, and student support. The study highlighted the program's key strengths, including a well-organized and flexible curriculum, skilled teachers, and student-centered teaching methods. However, it also noted areas that need improvement, such as laboratory facilities and hands-on activities, which are crucial in science education (Basagre, 2024).

On the employability front, studies on the Bachelor of Secondary Education with a major in science have shown promising outcomes. A tracer study by Harry Reusia et al. (2020) aimed to assess the employability of Science Education graduates and found that most secured relevant

employment. The graduates are equipped with the necessary knowledge, skills, and attitude, as manifested by the majority of students having a satisfactory licensure (LET) passing rate. The passion and commitment for teaching have been developed among the graduates. The science education program areas are effective, and the program outcomes are adequate and relevant, as demonstrated by the high average rating from the graduates.

Generally, the Commission on Higher Education Memorandum Order (CMO) No. 75, series of 2017, implements the policies, standards, and guidelines for administering the Bachelor of Secondary Education. Every program is expected to produce graduates who possess mastery in the subject matter, adhere to professional ethics, and apply the knowledge and skills acquired in the real world. It is designed to equip learners with the necessary and relevant competencies to teach in their chosen area of specialization at the secondary level, aiming to develop teachers with a strong sense of motivation and skill who specialize in secondary education. Additionally, the memorandum highlights the importance of expertise in various fields of study, ensuring that graduates acquire a broad range of skills in both pedagogy and content. It also indicated the different learning outcomes that graduates must achieve, aligning with field-specialized courses to ensure proficiency in education, professional development, and mastery of the subject matter. The objective of the memorandum is to equip college graduates with the skills needed for various types of employment.

Employability Skills

Solís et al. (2024) state that employability skills or job skills gained through education help individuals become qualified, find a job, and maintain decent work. Job skills are essential for preservice, in addition to what they have learned in college. Therefore, graduates are more likely to secure jobs and compete effectively across local, national, and global markets (Kadel, 2021). In

addition, Mat Sakam et al. (2022) highlight that teachers with employability skills can plan and implement lessons through a variety of activities using different strategies.

Omar et al. (2023) illustrate that due to economic problems and the growing demands of key industries, the job market has become increasingly unstable. In the last few decades, even graduates with higher education have struggled to get jobs after finishing their studies. However, research has shown that graduates often lack essential skills, such as communication, problem-solving, and English proficiency, which makes it more challenging to find employment (Ong et al., 2022).

Moreover, Azhar et al. (2020) emphasize that developing students' employability skills is crucial for preparing them for their future careers. However, the misalignment between graduates' employability skills and industry leads to joblessness among local graduates. Anuja Gopal et al. (2024) explain that this occurs because the modern workplace is changing quickly, making employability skills very important. In a highly competitive job market, individuals with strong employability skills attract the attention of employers. Hence, students require a specific set of skills, in addition to their educational qualifications, to secure jobs. This set of skills varies from country to country, resulting in different systems for employability skills that clearly define the required skills and attitudes.

At some point, Jyothi & Sampath Kumar (2022) note that the problem of being "educated but unemployed" has become more common in recent years. Graduates from various courses across the country are having a hard time finding jobs that match their academic degree and offer a competitive salary. Employers do not readily accept fresh graduates because they believe these graduates lack the necessary skills to perform the job. Even with high grades, graduates often fail to impress employers during interviews, as employers expect them to possess employability skills

in addition to good grades to perform a job effectively. Employability skills are essential for graduates to secure employment and achieve career success. Thus, to meet this era's challenges, graduates need to be good at the skills necessary in modern workplaces, to ensure they can perform successfully in their jobs, and use their learned skills for their own benefit, as well as for the employers and the economy (Obi et al., 2020; Poláková et al., 2023).

Lastly, employability skills have also been identified as the most essential aspect sought after by employers. It acts as a performance indicator for employers in hiring new employees. From employers' perspectives, the employability skills students possess will help them address challenges faced by the company and resolve the problems encountered (Rohanai et al., 2020). Therefore, young people need to acquire essential employability skills, including basic skills, critical thinking skills, personal quality skills, resource and capability skills, interpersonal skills, information skills, and system and technological skills (Holidi, Aslinda, & Seman, 2023).

Basic Skills

The UNESCO Glossary of Curriculum Terminology defines basic skills as the essential knowledge needed for learning, work, and life. These include both factual knowledge and practical skills. Basic skills also encompass a wide range of abilities that enable people to live successfully in today's society. In addition, according to the definition, basic skills are not fixed or permanent; instead, they evolve and grow in response to the changing needs and progress of humanity. They are key skills needed in the modern world, supporting personal growth, Education, and career success. These skills are broad and can be applied in many situations, making them valuable across various areas of life. As people grow, these basic skills serve as the foundation for learning more advanced skills (Hoogland, 2023).

Saleh & Lamsali (2020) state that fundamental skills include reading, writing, calculating, and communicating. These skills also include the ability to speak well, not only in your own

language but also in other languages, such as English. They also cover basic computer application skills, such as using Word, interpreting graphs, and working with Excel, PowerPoint, and other information technologies. The study emphasized that these basic skills are essential for the organization to function effectively. Similarly, Holidi et al. (2023) explained that basic skills include crucial academic, personal, and teamwork skills that employees need. These skills include communicating effectively, listening attentively, being present, collaborating with others, being accountable, being honest, being flexible, being empathetic, and making informed and rational decisions. Basic skills are essential for adjusting to the job, collaborating with colleagues and leaders, and making meaningful contributions to the organization.

A study by Kerneža (2023) on fundamental skills required for teachers highlights the importance of being proficient in using chatbots. Teachers need basic skills with technology, such as using computers, internet applications, and understanding programming and artificial intelligence. Teachers must be ready for changes in how chatbots are used in Education and be willing to learn new skills to use this technology effectively in the classroom.

Therefore, a study by Aranda et al. (2022) on Basic Skills in Higher Education suggests that all levels in educational institutions should promote and develop the acquisition of skills, particularly transversal, generic, or foundational skills. These skills enable students to perform various work functions and adapt to different job roles. The generic or basic skills refer to common attributes that can be applied at any level, such as the capacity to learn, decision-making, and project design and management. These skills are developed in all study programs.

Generally, Kakooza Abdulazi (2025) states that researchers define employability skills in different ways. However, they commonly refer to the basic skills that individuals need to obtain, maintain, and succeed in a job. Additionally, Soundararajan et al. (2020) state that employability skills are essential for maintaining a job for an extended period. These skills typically encompass

personal attributes, achievement skills, and other abilities that enable employees to advance in their careers. Sangwan (2022) concluded that when educators who develop these skills foster engaging and supportive classrooms, they will enhance student success.

Thinking Skills

Thinking skills refer to an individual's ability to analyze, evaluate, organize, and utilize information. Thinking skills are essential for processing data effectively and devising creative solutions to problems. As a result, modern education systems focus on helping students develop advanced thinking skills from a young age to meet contemporary requirements (Ulu-Kalin & Kumandaş-Öztürk, 2024).

Similarly, Makhene (2022) states that critical thinking involves the ability to understand information and make informed decisions based on relevant information, which typically involves basic knowledge. Higher-order thinking skills include critical, analytical, creative, and reflective thinking, as well as decision-making and problem-solving. Therefore, thinking skills are essential in daily life, work, academics, and personal development, allowing people to make more conscious, flexible, and effective decisions.

Zainal Shah et al. (2022) found that problem-solving and thinking skills are considered the most essential soft skills for getting a job. According to the respondents surveyed, skills such as active listening, analysis, research, creativity, dependability, and decision-making are indicators of problem-solving and thinking skills. Therefore, people need to acquire and develop thinking skills to enhance their employability and succeed in their careers (de Campos et al., 2020).

Furthermore, Alsaleh & Alsaleh (2020) emphasized that critical thinking (CT) is recognized as a key thinking skill and a primary measure of student learning quality. To develop successful

critical thinkers, critical thinking must be incorporated into the curriculum content and teaching approaches, and it should be sequenced at all grade levels. Mohamed Nor & Sihes (2021) noted that if students possess these skills, they will be best prepared to work collaboratively, think critically and analytically, communicate effectively, and solve problems efficiently in the workplace. Therefore, the acquisition of critical thinking skills is vital for teachers. A teacher should be prepared to identify which strategy or method can improve students' thinking skills and how to build a suitable learning environment (Kanmaz 2022).

Personal Quality Skills

Vasylenko et al. (2022) state that soft skills encompass a set of personality traits and social skills that significantly impact an individual's ability to work effectively and interact with others. It can be defined as a combination of personal qualities, abilities, attitudes, and habits that allow people to deal effectively with the challenges of professional and everyday life. It is explained that these soft skills enable them to understand their own actions better and collaborate more effectively with others, making employees more effective in their work and helping them achieve their goals (Čuić Tanković et al. 2021).

In line with this, Ismail et al. (2023) investigated how grit facilitates the connection between personal traits and essential job skills. They found that grit strengthens the link between traits such as career agility, cultural ingenuity, and proactive career resilience, as well as skills like autonomy/leadership, and personal employability qualities. These finding shows that helping people build grit can improve their chances of getting and keeping a job in today's changing work environment.

Moreover, Holidi et al. (2023) state that these soft skills are represented as traits and characteristics that enhance an individual's professionalism and work ethic. These skills include presence, collaboration, accountability, honesty, adaptability, and empathy. Employers valued

personal qualities because they reflect an individual's capacity to work well with others, take responsibility for their tasks, act with honesty, adapt to changing circumstances, and express empathy towards coworkers and customers. Thus, skills are essential for individuals to succeed in their jobs and make competent contributions to their organizations.

Feraco et al. (2023) state that soft skills are personal qualities that help manage emotions, behavior, and cognition, thereby enabling us to reach our goals. These skills are in high demand in the labor market, increasing people's chances of securing a job, succeeding in the workplace, and enhancing their creative outputs. On the other hand, Molina-Moreno et al. (2024) suggest that teachers with strong personal qualities can foster a safe and supportive classroom environment. A teacher's personal qualities help students learn more effectively and develop skills such as empathy, peaceful conflict resolution, improved well-being, enhanced academic performance, and personal growth.

Gabrele D. Cubero (2022) states that the personal qualities of teachers should be commitment, consistency, and fairness. A calm personality is essential for teachers because it is rooted in calmness, which flows easily with all its variations (Lukman et al., 2021).

Resource and capabilities skills

A resource is an asset controlled or owned by an organization that can be used for an extended period. Capability refers to an organization's capacity to perform a set of tasks using its resources to achieve specific goals (D'Oria et al., 2021). Supporting this idea, Ragadu & Rothmann (2025) concluded that while job resources are essential for providing the tools and support employees need to perform their jobs effectively, the capabilities approach helps by enabling employees to use these resources in ways that align their personal values and goals. These actions lead to more substantial and lasting engagement and commitment to the organization.

Furthermore, Holidi & Seman (2023) emphasize that resource and capability skills related to an individual's talents and abilities contribute to successfully reaching their potential within an organization. This ability emerged differently between the student and the employer, with each having different ideas of what is needed for success in work and life. To obtain a job, candidates must have these skills. People must possess the necessary resources and capabilities to meet job standards, adapt to job needs, and contribute to achieving organizational goals (Holidi, Aslinda, Seman, et al., 2023).

Garcia-Chitiva & Correa (2024) stated that the curriculum is carefully designed to give students the hands-on experience they need for their future careers. They teach essential skills, knowledge, and abilities that prepare student to face realistic challenges in their future careers. Employers value graduates who have completed a relevant curriculum because these graduates have the right resources and tools to excel in their careers. Moreover, educational institutions are increasingly integrating skills into their curricula to help students prepare for the changing job market and succeed in various work environments. These qualities make students more attractive to employers and improve their chances of finding good jobs.

Studies show that students' success can be significantly improved by incorporating employability skills into the curriculum and the school's teaching and learning culture. Different groups involved with employability see its importance in various ways (Rana et al., 2023). Othman et al. (2022) state in their study that it is beneficial for students to enhance their career adaptability while studying at the university. Enhancing career adaptability helps them become employable in the future and prevents difficulties in finding suitable jobs later.

Moreover, van der Baan et al. (2024) note that coaching is associated with the development of generic competences. A coach offers students opportunities to practice these

skills in a real-world work setting. Coaching is a complex process in which coaches provide students with various forms of support to enhance their employability and career development. Allocating these types of support enables a tailored approach to learning. Yang et al. (2025) emphasized that the acquisition of resources plays a crucial role in driving entrepreneurial growth. In the context of entrepreneurial skills, the ability to recognize opportunities and handle operations helps connect human, social, and material resources to growth performance.

Interpersonal Skills

Interpersonal skills are the ability to inspire, lead, and negotiate to manage relationships with people who contribute to your professional growth. Interpersonal skills are the skills used to interact and connect with colleagues and superiors by sensitivity, empathy, humor, mentoring, networking, patience, tolerance, public speaking, positive reinforcement, and diplomacy. Employees with interpersonal skills are considered a competitive advantage for achieving success in an organization (Sabreya Khanom Zuma, 2020).

Similarly, Holidi, Aslinda, Seman, et al. (2023) state in their study that interpersonal skills refer to the ability to communicate, collaborate, and engage with others in a professional setting. Strong communication skills, teamwork, leadership, and the capacity to develop and maintain relationships are examples of these talents. Employers value interpersonal skills because they help create a positive work environment, strong teamwork, and successful client interactions. Hence, in the study by Bedoya-Guerrero et al. (2024) on soft skills and employability, it was emphasized that graduates need to show skills in communication, teamwork, leadership, self-discipline, adaptability, innovation, and critical thinking. These skills span the interpersonal, social, and cross-cutting domains, making them essential for both securing employment and being responsible

citizens. The study concluded that soft skills, also known as interpersonal skills, are crucial in shaping competent professionals for the workforce.

A study by Ndiung & Menggo (2024) highlights that interpersonal skills are essential in human life. The study explained that these skills are key for people and societies to connect in their daily activities. It affects how people act, especially in schools, where students need clear and understandable communication with their professors. Interpersonal skills are the exchange of information, ideas, and self-expression through both spoken words and non-verbal methods such as body language, symbols, and pictures.

Moreover, interpersonal skills play a crucial role in the workplace, both in the relationships between supervisors and employees and among coworkers**.** Klinkosz et al. (2021) stated that key aspects of interpersonal skills include the ability to respond appropriately and effectively to different social situations, handle various interpersonal challenges, and derive satisfaction from social interactions and relationships. Therefore, understanding the importance of interpersonal skills, schools and universities have offered programs and courses to develop students' communication skills. These efforts are driven by employers' expectations that graduates possess interpersonal skills suitable for various workplace settings.

Lastly, Schislyaeva & Saychenko (2022) highlight the importance of interpersonal skills. It has been noted that today's workplace is undergoing rapid changes due to the introduction of new technologies. People now work in groups that connect both within their own country and across the world with those from different cultures. To succeed, employees need strong interpersonal skills to collaborate effectively and understand their co-workers.

Information Skills

Information skills are defined as the ability to apply higher-level thinking to find and utilize information in various formats and settings, while using it ethically to enhance our lives. Information skills are also recognized as other forms of literacy, including digital and media information literacy (Robertson, 2021). In addition, Holidi, Aslinda, Seman, et al. (2023) emphasized that information skills involve the ability to effectively organize and utilize information to aid in decision-making and problem-solving. Critical thinking, information literacy, communication, and lifelong learning are examples of these skills. People must have strong information skills to improve their chances of getting a job and succeed in today's information-based world.

A study by Gündüzalp (2021) on 21st-century skills for Sustainable Education emphasized that it is essential for teachers to possess both information and digital literacy skills. Teachers who teach students raised with technology, known as Generation Z, need to enhance both information literacy and digital literacy skills. In Education, teachers play a key role in integrating and implementing ICT, as well as being experts in teaching. The successful application of ICT in education depends on teachers' readiness to use technological tools (Peciuliauskiene et al., 2022). Therefore, a study by Li & Fan (2025) on "How Preservice Teachers' Career Planning Affects Perceived Employability in the Digital Age" suggests that there is a need for preservice teachers to increase the frequency of their practice in the digital space, to grasp employment information, and to prepare for employment through a variety of digital means based on clear job search goals, and thus develop their chances of employability.

Moreover, a study by van Laar et al. (2020) highlights the importance of employees being able to search, evaluate, and organize data, as the volume of information increases from various sources. With easy access to a wide range of information, people need to know how to discern

when the information is valuable and reliable. In line with this, Khalid et al. (2020) concluded that as we enter the Fourth Industrial Revolution, employers expect graduates to have ICT skills, the ability to learn independently, and strong information and analytical skills. Simply knowing how to search for information is no longer enough; graduates must be able to select, combine, and utilize data in informed decision-making. Additionally, being able to communicate effectively using the right digital platforms and media is now recognized as a crucial skill.

System Technological Skills

Technological skills refer to the ability to understand, operate, and manage various digital tools and technologies, enabling full advantage of ICTs. These skills encompass a wide range of technologies, including the use of technology, communication and sharing, content and knowledge creation, information organization and processing, adherence to ethical principles, data evaluation, and problem-solving (Elshaer et al., 2025). In addition, the study by Rodrigues et al. (2021) states that technological skills are already essential in today's knowledge society and appear crucial to people's future life satisfaction, alongside basic skills. The study found that the main skills of the 21st century, including critical thinking, problem-solving, communication, and technological skills, along with age and income, all have a positive effect on life satisfaction.

On the other hand, technology proficiency is the ability to use technology, communicate effectively, organize information, create high-quality products, and enhance thinking skills. In the classroom, technology proficiency refers to teachers' ability to utilize technology for teaching, facilitating student learning, and enhancing productivity and performance (Saad & Sankaran, 2020).

In today's digital world, utilizing technology in education is essential for schools to meet the needs of a more connected society. Osorio Vanegas et al. (2025) state that teachers play a significant role in facilitating students' learning, guiding them, and improving their educational

experience. Thus, teachers need to be trained in 21st-century skills and in using digital technologies effectively to enhance teaching and learning. In addition, Caratiquit & Javier (2025) state that in the 21st century, teachers are expected to possess strong digital skills, referred to as being tech-savvy, as technology is a big part of modern education. The enhancement of these skills demonstrates teachers' proficiency in using ICT tools and processes for teaching and learning. Using ICT in the classroom improves access to quality education, promotes inclusivity, empowers students, and supports long-term development.

Similarly, state that rapid technological advancement has transformed teaching into one of the world's most demanding professions. Teachers are increasingly expected to integrate digital technologies into their teaching practices. Studies show that teachers who feel confident in using technology tend to use it more often in their work. Teachers' self-perceived technological skills significantly impact the degree to which they utilize technology; learning to use various technological tools increases their use of these tools (Yavich & Davidovitch, 2024).

Sex

The online Merriam-Webster Dictionary defines "sex" as "either of the two major forms of individuals that occur in many species and that are distinguished respectively as female or male, especially based on their reproductive organs and structures." (Schiappa, 2021)**.** Similarly, Quintana & Pfaus (2024) in their study on "Do Sex and Gender Have Separate Identities", explained that sex is primarily defined by DNA and chromosomes, while also being influenced by hormones. It is typically determined by the visible anatomy and physiology of the external genital organs, which reveal sexual differences.

Meanwhile, biological sex has been found to influence how people perceive and respond to employment situations, both mentally and biologically. A study on biological sex as a moderator of work determinants of health by Hart et al. (2024) found that women who went through

negative experiences at work showed physical signs of stress. On the other hand, men also showed stress in their bodies, even when they were active and engaged in their jobs.

Moreover, studies show how biological sex affects employability. For instance, Mainga et al. (2025) found that male students felt 50% more confident in their skills than female students. Pitan & Muller (2020) found that male students were more optimistic about their future employability compared to female students, indicating that the job market viewed men more favorably than women.

Eligibility

Eligibility refers to the result of passing a merit and fitness test which may be determined as far as practicable by competitive examination, or based on highly technical qualifications, or other tests of merit and fitness conducted by the CSC, or other examinations jointly designed and coordinated by the departments or agencies with the assistance of or in coordination with the CSC, and other examinations. For teaching positions, the applicable eligibility shall be the Professional Regulation Commission's Licensure Examination for Professional Teachers (LEPT) (Department of Education, 2024).

A study by Jaji & Russell (2025) on the Philippine Licensure Examination for Professional Teachers highlighted that the LEPT is crucial in ensuring that qualified individuals enter the teaching profession. The LEPT serves as a gateway for Filipinos with Bachelor's degrees and professional education units to pursue their teaching careers. In line with this, Gopez & Eniego (2024) state that most schools require teachers to have a license before they accept their application. For public schools in the Philippines, having a teacher's license is an essential requirement.

According to Abao et al. (2023), the licensure examination is one of the hurdles aspiring professionals must pass. It is administered to assess whether candidates have the skills and abilities to perform their duties effectively. It has become a meaningful way to ensure that teachers hired in schools are qualified. The exam sets a standard to determine whether a graduate possesses the essential skills needed to be a teacher. Once candidates pass the exam, they receive a license that allows them to practice their profession.

Moreover, studies have shown that Eligibility significantly impacts employability qualifications for teachers. A survey by Dela Cruz & Dela Cruz (2023) on the employment and employability skills of graduate school graduates found that these graduates possess the necessary qualifications, hold permanent positions in public schools, and work in roles related to their degree earned. The Graduate School instilled the essential skills graduates need to perform their duties, functions, and responsibilities in their respective jobs. These help them demonstrate the necessary attributes in the workplace.

Highest Educational Attainment

Highest educational attainment refers to the most advanced level of Education a person has achieved. It involves both formal and informal education, including internships and job training. Formal education involves earning degrees or other credentials. When assessing educational attainment, educational credentials like high school diplomas, college degrees, Bachelor's degrees, master's degrees, or doctoral degrees are commonly used as standards. Additionally, educational attainment has a significant influence on employment opportunities. Higher education credentials typically give job seekers a better chance of getting jobs over their competitors. Higher education provides people with highly demanding, specialized knowledge, skills, and critical thinking competencies. Employers commonly place a high value on adaptable

skills acquired through higher education, including teamwork, communication, and problem-solving, all of which are important for success in the modern workplace (Qin, 2023).

Many studies show that higher levels of education, especially graduate degrees, lead to better employment outcomes, higher pay, promotions, and greater job satisfaction. For example, Bautista Jr et al. (2023) found that the skills and knowledge they acquired in school are valuable to their jobs, and enhance their rankings and salaries. Those in higher positions and with higher monthly salaries believe the skills they acquired are directly related to their current work. The results also show that the university's goal of being the top choice for employable graduates is reflected in the workplace.

Maghamil (2025) emphasized that graduate education significantly enhances career opportunities by providing graduates with better job prospects, opportunities for promotions, and higher salaries. A graduate degree not only provides individuals with the knowledge and skills necessary to advance in their careers but also enhances their competitiveness in the job market. As a result, graduate education serves as a stepping stone to secure better and more stable jobs, higher positions, and greater earning potential, making it a wise investment for long-term career success. It is recommended that graduate programs continue to focus on both professional growth and moral education to better prepare students for the workforce.

Similarly, Guzman (2025) found that graduates of the Doctor of Education program are highly satisfied with their current jobs and earn an average monthly salary of 30,000 to 38,000. In terms of the adequacy and relevance of the curriculum, the respondents perceived the program as adequate and highly relevant, particularly due to the faculty's mastery of their subject matter, pedagogical competence, and adherence to professional and ethical standards. Regarding their employment ability, they are perceived as highly important and possess strong competence in

skills such as research and development, as well as life and career skills. Overall, most participants believed that the immediate impact of graduating from a Doctor of Education program is promotion and designation.

Monthly Income

Monthly income is commonly used in tracer studies to measure the amount of money employees earn or receive in a single month (Aliemar Villasin, 2024; Apostol & Susada, 2022; Victoriano et al., 2022). Additionally, according to Indeed, gross monthly income is defined as the total amount a person earns per month, before any taxes are taken out. It includes all types of income, such as regular salary, money from side jobs or freelance work, and money from investments.

In line with this, studies have shown that an employee's monthly income varies based on their position within the workplace. For instance, Cornillez Jr. et al. (2021) found that the income of most graduates in their first job is ₱5,000 to less than ₱10,000. Meanwhile, Patulin et al. (2024) found that regular teachers working in the Department of Education (DepEd) earn a base salary ranging from ₱15,000 to ₱25,000 per month. On the other hand, those in permanent supervisory or managerial positions at DepEd earn monthly salaries ranging from ₱25,000 to ₱50,000.

In connection with income levels, salary is also recognized as a motivating factor for seeking employment and pursuing further education. Supporting this, Cadawas & Cadawas (2022) found that most teachers worked side jobs because their salaries were insufficient to fulfill their financial and personal needs. Their monthly income from their full-time employment was primarily allocated to regular expenses, including debt/bill payments, household expenses, and the children's tuition fees.

Aligning with these findings, Teves & Ubayubay (2024) found that teachers pursue graduate degree programs to increase income, enhance job security, self-motivation, and financial stability. Bahilot et al. (2024) emphasized that money serves as a source of motivation and a crucial component of every successful endeavor.

Nature of Work

In just a few decades, progress in computer technology has had a profound impact on the types of work we do, the design of our workplaces, how we communicate with each other, and the nature of work itself. The continuous rise of computers and mobile devices in our daily lives, along with the rapid growth of artificial intelligence technologies, is truly remarkable (Berrell, 2024).

A study by Blustein et al. (2025) differentiates decent work and meaningful work. It was stated that decent work represents basic workplace conditions to which all employees are entitled. In contrast, meaningful work is aspirational, reflecting significance within the work environment.

Michael Mindzak (2024) emphasized that teachers' work encompasses a broader range of activities, including both paid and unpaid efforts that contribute to students, schools, the educational environment, and wider communities. These efforts often go beyond contractual obligations embedded in the paid employment relationship (the job). Teachers are aware of this, as are the labor organizations that represent them. They often engage in both work and labor as part of their defined and undefined roles and responsibilities. Hence, the difficulty in redefining teachers' work arises from the need to capture the broad, multifaceted, and dynamic nature of the role, which encompasses both the formal tasks for which they are paid and also the myriad ways they contribute to the intellectual, emotional, and social development of their students and schools.

Place of Work

According to Masoom (2021), the work environment is where people perform their tasks. Oyedeji et al. (2025) describe the workplace environment as a physical and organized space, such as the building where employees work, where the main activities of an organization take place. The work environment encompasses all the tools and materials a person uses, the physical space where they work, the manner in which they perform their tasks, and the way they organize their work, both individually and collaboratively (Sonny et al., 2025). On the other hand, the workplace can be understood as the physical location or place where people perform their jobs (de Lucas Ancillo et al. 2021).

Shaari et al. (2022) state that to remain competitive within a particular industry, companies must focus more on employee performance and provide an environment that enables them to perform at their best. A workplace that is unsafe or unhealthy has a detrimental effect on work performance. Thus, it is an employer's responsibility to provide proper working conditions for employees (Hulls et al., 2020).

Furthermore, Gao (2024) emphasized that the work environment plays a crucial role in shaping employees' productivity, motivation, and overall job satisfaction. Teachers might be more productive and achieve their full potential if they had a safe and comfortable workplace with the proper working conditions (Abbas et al. 2022). Also, a conducive work environment further enhances job performance, confirming the critical role of a well-structured climate in fostering productivity and commitment among teachers (Emmanuel Eshun, 2025).

Ortan et al. (2021) found that an efficient work environment reduces attrition, burnout, emotional exhaustion, and teacher turnover, while simultaneously increasing job satisfaction, well-being, and teacher retention. Supporting this, Ker et al. (2022) conclude that teacher job satisfaction is strongly associated with the work environment. The study suggests that schools can

improve teachers' job satisfaction by creating a supportive and positive work environment, which in turn helps enhance teaching effectiveness. Building on this, Zhenjing et al. (2022) found that a positive work environment fosters employee performance within organizational circuits. A positive work environment provides a nurturing atmosphere that promotes employee commitment and leads to greater loyalty to their organizations.

Generally, Nonye & Ugwuama (2025) stated that the work environment encompasses all forces, actions, and other influential factors that are currently or potentially competing with the employee's activities and performance. The work environment refers to the interrelationship between employees and the setting in which they work. Comfortable environmental conditions encourage good work habits for teachers. The comfort and feasibility of the work environment can foster positive mental and physical health performance.

Employment Sector

A sector is a category of industries that includes companies engaged in similar or related types of business, such as agriculture or technology (Will Kenton, 2025). In line with this, a job sector is a term used to classify a large group of jobs and industries that are connected by the type of work they perform. Understanding which sector your current or previous job belongs to can help you understand the economy and the goals of different industries. In general, the six major job sectors are health care, information technology, real estate and development, Education, agriculture, and government (Indeed, 2025).

Meanwhile, in the study of H. Li et al. (2024) emphasized that an individual's educational background plays a significant role in securing employment in the public sector. Individuals who hold college degrees, particularly in humanities and social sciences, are more likely to secure public sector jobs. Employment in the public sector typically offers higher wages, improved benefits, and

greater job stability compared to employment in the private sector. The majority of public sector employee express satisfaction with their job security. Public sector jobs may provide superior working conditions and other long-term career advantages.

However, a study by Suhi et al. (2021) on the influencing factors in career selection among university graduates from Bangladesh demonstrates that male and female university graduates have different job preferences. The research indicates that male students tend to prefer working in the private sector. In contrast, female students are more interested in public sector jobs, reflecting societal gender roles. Male students are more likely to be interested in the private sector because men often have family responsibilities, such as providing financial support to their parents and siblings. As a result, they tend to seek challenging or complicated jobs that pay well in the private sector. On the other hand, female students prefer public sector jobs. Women typically choose careers perceived as more suitable for them, such as teaching or office work, because these roles offer job security, a steady income, and flexibility to balance family responsibilities.

Moreover, in the teaching profession, some teachers prefer working in private schools, while others choose public schools. A comparative analysis by Fatima et al. (2024) highlights the differences in job satisfaction between public and private teachers. The results show that public university teachers are more satisfied with factors such as independence, social status, recognition, job security, success, the use of their skills, and relationships with colleagues. In contrast, private university teachers find more satisfaction in aspects such as job variety, responsibility, creativity, opportunities for growth, university rules, working conditions, and pay policies.

Similarly, Small (2020) stated that private schools can be more attractive to teachers and future teachers because they offer greater freedom in classroom decision-making and provide

administrative support. It also mentioned that teachers are less likely to quit in the private school setting due to its positive working environment and shared values and beliefs.

Employment Category

Employment categories refer to different groups of workers based on the kind of job they do and their work conditions. These categories help employers understand the work relationship they have with each worker, which affects pay, benefits, and legal rights (Zaidi, 2025). Employment categories also show how a person's work is organized based on their contract and working hours, such as full-time, part-time, or casual work. This term is used in the study to classify workers according to their specific work setup and commitments (Gaytos et al., 2025).

Meanwhile, Kim et al. (2021) elaborate that the job market is clearly divided into two types of employment: outsider and insider employment. Outsider employment refers to jobs such as part-time, temporary, and casual work that do not offer job security or benefits. On the other hand, insider employment refers to full-time and permanent work that provides a comprehensive package of occupational benefits, including health insurance, pension security, and disability income.

In the teaching profession, studies have shown that most graduates were employed in regular or permanent positions. Reyes et al. (2025) explain that the effectiveness of the program curricula and the relevance of the skills and knowledge are key factors in successfully equipping graduates with the competencies needed for their chosen careers. Additionally, educational qualifications are the most significant factor in their initial employment (Vidania et al., 2023).

In contrast, factors such as curriculum mismatch, financial constraints, and limited local job opportunities contribute to the instability of employability among graduates. The study by Kaamiño & Pasion (2025) found that the short and unstable early jobs of graduate teachers show the challenges they face in getting long-term, secure teaching positions. Even though they are

employed, many graduates feel uncertain about their future careers due to job insecurity and limited growth opportunities. Aside from that, challenges such as licensure delays, limited job opportunities in rural areas, and financial constraints affect the employability of some graduates (Selda & Galicia, 2025).

Employment Status

Employment status refers to the contractual aspects of a job, including its duration, the number of hours worked, and the financial risk, control, and power a worker has in the job. The main types are employees and self-employed individuals. Employees are individuals who receive compensation from an employer or a temporary agency, with a distinction between those with permanent or fixed-term contracts (Eurofound, 2024).

A study conducted by Ferolino et al. (2023) aimed to assess the employability status of graduates. The study found that most employed graduates secured their first job within six months of graduation. The respondents express overall satisfaction with the delivery of undergraduate programs, as their jobs are closely related to the courses they completed, and the curriculum is practically beneficial to their careers. However, studies have shown that graduates often face challenges in finding employment. These challenges include a lack of self-confidence, financial pressure, the desire to seek better job/career opportunities, and limited or no work experience.

Similarly, Salendab & Dapitan (2025) found that BSEd graduates had a high employment rate, with many securing stable teaching positions locally. Graduates rated the relevance of their degree to their present work as highly relevant, highlighting competencies in research, communication, and leadership as pivotal in meeting workplace demands. However, studies have shown that lack of work experience and ongoing preparation for the Licensure Examination for Teachers were highlighted as the main factors contributing to unemployment.

On the other hand, factors found that employees stay in their jobs due to competitive pay and benefits, positive work relationships, and challenging work (Guevarra et al., 2025)**.** Similarly, in the teaching profession, salaries and benefits are the primary reason why most teachers stay in their jobs (Duane Biscante et al., 2020). In addition, Espra & Valle (2025) emphasized that salary and benefits, workplace environment, job responsibilities, and community attachment and linkages were statistically linked to teachers' professional commitment. It also explained that more teachers are satisfied with their jobs when their dedication to service is well compensated through salary increases and benefits. Additionally, the school administrators and stakeholders acknowledged their efforts.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study is anchored on the Human Capital Theory, the Self-Determination Theory, and the Theory of Employability. The Human Capital Theory was introduced by the American economist Gary S. Becker in 1960 and Theodore W. Shultz in 1961. The Self-Determination Theory (SDT) was established by American Psychologists Deci & Ryan (1985), and the Theory of Employability was proposed by Knight & Yorke (2002).

The Human Capital Theory explains the connection between Education and productivity. It emphasizes that human capital plays a key role in understanding how Education, skills, and training can improve a person's economic productivity. According to Schultz, investments in Education, training, and healthcare can significantly increase labor productivity. The return on these investments is much higher than that of physical capital. Becker also explained that investments in Education, training, and health can affect income distribution and economic growth by improving individual productivity.

This theory is particularly relevant for this study, especially in the context of a tracer study. This theory emphasizes the responsibility of Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) such as Saint Michael College of Caraga to enhance students' employability and improve their career opportunities. By examining alums career outcomes, the study will assess whether the knowledge and skills students gain in school lead to real economic and professional benefits. Through this, the tracer study will help determine how well the school's investment in human capital leads to future career success and makes a positive impact on society.

Moreover, Fei et al. (2025) state that human capital is the skills, knowledge, and abilities an individual gains through Education, training, and work experience. Education is a key investment in human capital because it enables individuals to acquire the knowledge, skills, and values that enhance their productivity and employability. Training helps individuals enhance their skills and expertise to meet changing job requirements. Work experience, an essential component of human capital, refers to the knowledge, job-related skills, and professional judgment that individuals acquire through practical work.

In connection with Deci & Ryan's (1985) theory of self-determination, it helps explain how graduates' motivation to complete their degree can enhance their skills and increase their chances of securing a job. The theory emphasizes that people are naturally inspired to take control of their lives and strive for personal growth. Individuals wish to improve by setting their own goals, learning new things, and engaging with others. This theory aligns with the tracer study, as it provides a framework to understand how college graduates work hard to improve their job prospects. It also illustrates how graduates work hard while in college to enhance their skills and readiness for the workforce, thereby increasing their chances of securing a fulfilling job after graduation.

On the other hand, Yorke and Knight's (2004) theory of employability posits that employability stems from a person's accomplishments, learning, and understanding of individual skills, which enable them to succeed in their chosen careers. Gyepi-Garbrah & Preko (2024) define employability as a set of skills, knowledge, and abilities that help individuals find and maintain jobs, grow professionally, and adapt to workplace changes.

Therefore, in this study, the human capital, self-determination, and employability theory served as a framework for analyzing how graduates' determination and investments in Education and training translate into real career outcomes. By examining employment status, job relevance, and career progression of graduates, the tracer study assessed whether the competencies and skills acquired in school were effectively applied in the workplace. In this way, the theories provided a foundation for evaluating the effectiveness of the institution's academic programs and their alignment with labor market demands. Anchoring the study on this theory highlights the direct link between Education, skill development, and employability, while also offering valuable feedback for curriculum enhancement and institutional planning.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

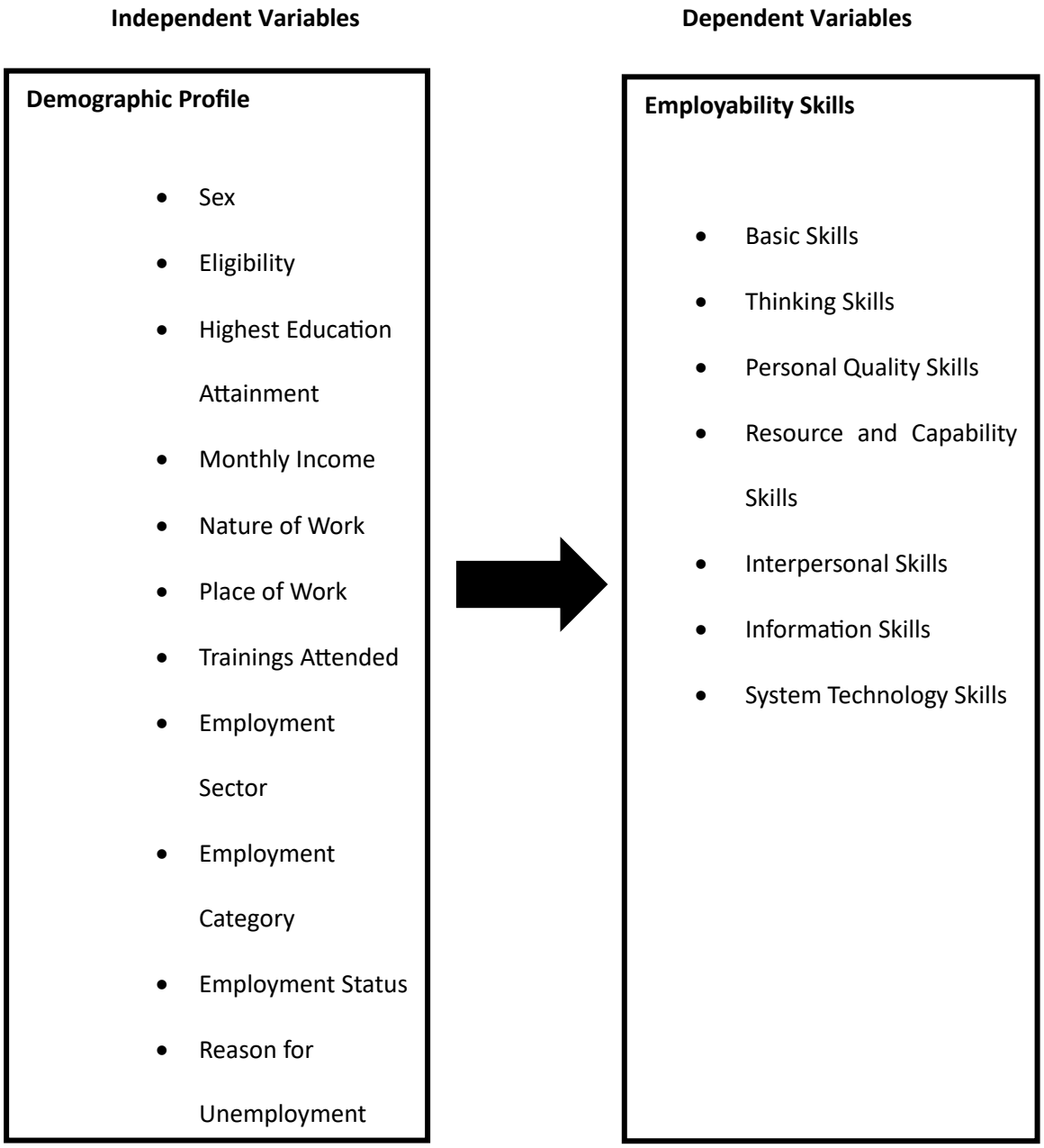


Figure 1. *The schematic diagram illustrates the study's paradigm.*

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

The purpose of this study is to determine if the graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from the Bachelor of Secondary Education majoring in Technical-Vocational Education, Physical Education, English, and Science were successful in their chosen careers.

Specifically, it will seek to answer the following questions.

1. What is the profile of teacher education graduates in terms of:

1.1. sex;

1.2. eligibility;

1.3. highest educational attainment;

1.4. monthly income;

1.5. nature of work;

1.6. place of work;

1.7 trainings attended; and

1.7 Educational Background

- BPED
- BTVTED
- BSED ENGLISH
- BSED SCIENCE

2. What is the extent of employment profile of SMCC's Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from the 2022–2024 batch in terms of:

2.1 employment sector;

2.2 employment category;

2.3 employment status; and

2.4 reason for unemployment?

3. What employability skills acquired in college did the respondents find useful in their job/ future jobs?

3.1 basic skills;

3.2 thinking skills;

3.3 personal quality skills;

3.4 resource and capability skills;

3.5 interpersonal skills;

3.6 information skills; and

3.7 system technology skills?

4. Is there a significant difference between the skills acquired in college and their employment profile?

5. Is there a significant relationship between the skills learned in college and their employment profile?

Hypothesis

The hypothesis will guide the study and be tested at a 0.5 level of significance.

H_1: There is no significant difference between the skills learned in college and their employment profile.

H_2: There is no significant relationship between the skills learned in college and their employment profile.

1.6 Scope and Limitations

This study will focus on the employability of Teacher Education graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024. Graduates who earned a Bachelor's degree in Secondary Education, with majors in Technical-Vocational Education, Physical Education, English,

and Science, will be the respondents in this study. The goal is to gather personal information, their job situations, and their professional development. The study also examines the practical relevance of their major and professional subjects in their teaching careers. The data on their current jobs will be collected via a Google Forms survey, since many participants are outside the school. Lastly, this study aims to understand the employability skills that graduates have acquired through their Education and how well these skills assist them in their teaching jobs.

1.7 Definition of Terms

The following terms were operationally defined to achieve a more transparent and more precise understanding of the study.

Bachelor of Secondary Education. It portrays the Bachelor of Secondary Education programs of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Basic Skills. This term refers to the essential academic, personal, and communication skills acquired of Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Career. It refers to the jobs of Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Eligibility. This term refers to the Licensure Professional Teacher and Civil Service Eligibility acquired of the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Employed. It refers to the permanent paid positions of Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Employment category. It indicates whether Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates are employed under a regular contract of service, a job order, or a similar arrangement.

Employment sector. It refers to the areas where Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates are employed, such as private, government, or NGO.

Employment status. This term indicates whether graduates of the Bachelor of Secondary Education program from the 2020 to 2024 batch are employed or unemployed.

Employability skills. This term describes the set of skills, knowledge, and qualities that make the graduates of the Bachelor of Secondary Education program at Saint Michael College of Caraga attractive to employers.

Graduates. It refers to the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Highest educational attainment. It specifies the highest level of Education completed by the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Information skills. It examines the ability to organize and utilize information effectively to support decision-making and problem-solving among Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from the 2020 to 2024 batch at Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Interpersonal skills. This term refers to the ability to communicate, work with others, and interact with people effectively and professionally. These skills are developed by the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Monthly income. This term refers to the gross monthly income earned by the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga in their current jobs from 2020 to 2024.

Nature of work. This term identifies the specific type of job held by the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga, from batch 2020–2024.

Place of work. It refers to the locations where the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga are currently employed.

Personal quality skills. This term refers to the traits and characteristics that demonstrate a person's professionalism and work ethic. In the workplace, these skills enable Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga to plan, prioritize, and achieve their goals.

Resource and capability skills. It relates to the talents and competencies that enable Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024 to contribute effectively and realize their potential within an organization.

System technology skills. This term refers to the knowledge, talents, and abilities in using and managing various technological systems and tools that Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga acquired during the 2020-2024 batches.

Thinking skills. It indicates the ability to analyze, solve problems, and think critically in the workplace among Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Tracer study. It refers to the study of the employability of the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024.

Unemployed. It refers to the Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga from 2020 to 2024 who are unemployed but available to work.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter will discuss the research design, locale, respondents, ethical standards, and data-gathering procedures. It will also present the materials and instruments used in this research and explain how the researcher gathered data.

2.1 Research Design

This study will use a quantitative research method to trace the graduates of the Bachelor of Secondary Education program, majoring in Technical-Vocational Education, Physical Education, English, and Science, from the batches 2020-2024 at Saint Michael College of Caraga. This study will employ a descriptive-correlational approach to investigate the impact of skills and competencies acquired in college on employment status. Additionally, a correlation will measure the strength and direction of the relationship between two or more variables. The correlation will be either positive or negative, depending on the data gathered.

2.2 Research Locale

This study will be conducted at Saint Michael College of Caraga, located on Atupan Street, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. It is a private Roman Catholic institution under the management of the Roman Catholic Diocese of Butuan. The institution is situated beside the Saint Michael College Parish Church and directly faces the municipal plaza. The SMCC offers various programs, one of which is the Bachelor of Secondary Education. This program offers majors in Technical-Vocational Education, Physical Education, English, Science, Mathematics, and Social Studies, and has produced many graduates from the institution.

The College of Teacher Education was established in 2001, and offers Bachelor of Elementary Education and Bachelor of Secondary Education, initially offering a major in English. Over the years, the institution expanded its academic offerings to further strengthen its commitment to providing high-quality training and education for future educators. In 2018, the college introduced the Bachelor of Physical Education and the Bachelor of Technical-Vocational Teacher Education programs. These programs are designed to equip students with the essential skills, knowledge, and competencies needed to become qualified, reflective, and dedicated secondary teachers capable of creating meaningful and engaging learning experiences for high school students.

2.3 Research Respondents

Proposed Courses	S.Y. 2019-2020		S.Y. 2020-2021		S.Y. 2021-2022		S.Y. 2022-2023		S.Y. 2023-2024	
	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
BSED-English	8	26	8	21	2	21	11	41	3	22
BSED-Science									3	7
BTVTED					3	19	3	11		
BPED	8				11	7	9	25	13	14
Total		26	8	21	16	47	23	77	16	43

Table 1. It will show the distribution of respondents in the study.

The graduates of the Bachelor of Secondary Education majoring in English, Science, Technical-Vocational Teacher Education, and Physical Education from Saint Michael College of Caraga will be the respondents in this study, selected through a purposive sampling technique.

The study includes 285 graduates from Saint Michael College of Caraga, spanning the academic years 2020-2024. Overall, the data show that most graduates are female, totaling 214, while 71 are male from different programs.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Instrument

The researchers will develop a survey questionnaire anchored on the objectives of this study. It will undergo content validation by the research panel and pilot testing to ensure its reliability in gathering the necessary data. The questionnaire will cover the profile of BSED alum graduates based on sex, Eligibility, highest educational attainment, monthly income, nature of work, and place of work. It will also determine the extent of their employment status across various sectors and classifications. The instrument will include items assessing employability skills, such as basic skills, thinking skills, personal quality skills, resource and capability skills, interpersonal skills, information skills, and system technology skills. These skills, acquired during their college training, will aid them in their professional journey. The evaluation will consist of items rated on a 4-point Likert Scale, where one (1) will mean "Strongly Disagree," two (2) will mean "Disagree," three (3) will mean "Agree," and four (4) will mean "Strongly Agree." The instrument will be used to assess the degree to which the statements reflect the experiences of the BSED alum graduates from Batch 2022–2024.

Statistical Tools

The researchers will utilize the following statistical tools: Frequency and Percentage, Weighted Mean, Correlation Analysis, and Comparative Analysis to interpret the data gathered.

Frequency and Percentage. It will be used to determine the profile of teacher education graduates and assess the extent of employment status of Bachelor of Secondary Education graduates from 2020 to 2024.

Weighted Mean. It will be used to determine the employability skills learned in college that respondents find helpful in their jobs. These include basic skills, thinking skills, personal skills, resource and capability skills, interpersonal skills, information skills, and system technology skills.

Correlation Analysis. It will be used to determine if there is a significant relationship between the skills learned in college and their demographic profile in terms of income. This test will be used because income is a continuous variable, and skills learned are an ordinal-level variable. Data will also not be normally distributed.

Comparative Analysis. It will be used to determine whether there is a significant difference between the skills learned in college and the graduates' employment profile, including employment sector, category, status, nature of work, and place of work. This test will be used because the employment sector, category, status, nature of work, and place of work will be categorical/nominal variables. At the same time, skills learned will be an ordinal variable. The data will also not be normally distributed.

Data Analysis Steps

The information gathered in this study will be interpreted using appropriate statistical tools and methods to answer the objectives. It will utilize a descriptive-correlational approach to examine how the skills and competencies acquired in college affect their employment status. Correlation Analysis and Comparative Analysis will be utilized in this study to assess the relationship and differences between skills learned in college and graduates' employment profiles.

The researcher will design a survey questionnaire tailored to the objectives of this study, and it will be evaluated using a Four-Point Likert Scale. A higher point emphasized that graduates thoroughly learned and applied the skills indicated by SMCC. In comparison, a lower point indicates that graduates did not learn the skills displayed by SMCC. The analyzed result will then be interpreted to draw conclusions and recommendations aligned with the study's objectives. The analyzed result will then be interpreted to draw conclusions and recommendations aligned with the study's objectives.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

The researchers will place great importance on observing ethical considerations throughout this research process, particularly in conducting this tracer study among graduates from various majors within the Bachelor of Secondary Education programs.

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This research will not involve any new technology, process, or product that requires patent protection. It respects and upholds intellectual property rights. Thus, to uphold intellectual property rights, the researcher will ensure that all materials used are appropriately credited and protected under copyright laws. All third-party sources and secondary data will be appropriately acknowledged. Since the study will not create any brand, logo, or symbol, trademark registration will not be necessary.

B. Informed Consent

Before conducting this study, the researcher will obtain permission or consent from all BSED graduate respondents via a Google Form. The form will include a section where respondents can give their consent, allowing them to decide freely whether to participate in the study. Additionally, instead of signatures, the researchers included a clickable button in the Google

Survey Form that allowed respondents to indicate their agreement or refusal to participate. This process ensures that participants fully understand the study's purpose, procedures, possible risks, and benefits, allowing them to make an informed decision about their involvement.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The data for this study will be collected through a Google Form, with access to the responses restricted to the researchers. In compliance with R.A. 10173 or the Data Privacy Act of 2012, participant anonymity will be strictly maintained, and all information obtained will be used solely for research purposes. In addition, after the study's completion, all collected data will be permanently deleted or securely disposed of to ensure the complete protection of participants' privacy and confidentiality. The researchers will ensure that all the data is handled with utmost care.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

As part of the study, the researchers will ensure that respondents are not forced to participate; respondents' participation will be entirely voluntary. Respondents will be thoroughly informed of their right to withdraw from the research at any time without facing any negative consequences. This assurance aims to create a comfortable and respectful environment, ensuring that respondents from the Bachelor of Secondary Education program, majoring in Technical-Vocational, Physical Education, English, and Science, feel no obligation to continue if they choose not to. All responses will be collected with respondents' full permission, ensuring they are free to decide and feel safe and comfortable during the study.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

The researcher will always ensure that respondents do not experience any physical, psychological, or emotional harm. Since the data will be distributed and collected through an online platform, there will be no face-to-face interaction. Therefore, this allows respondents to provide their answers at their own convenience and in an environment where they feel most comfortable. The data will be encrypted, stored properly, and handled with care to protect the privacy and safety of the participants. The researchers will develop non-intrusive questions and avoid topics that might make the participants feel uncomfortable.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

This research will contribute to a better understanding of how the institution equips students with the employability skills necessary for success in real-world settings. Therefore, information from graduates helps the College of Teacher Education at Saint Michael College of Caraga attract more enrollees, enhance its curriculum, and strengthen its academic programs. However, the researcher believes that institutions play an essential role in helping graduates become independent individuals. Although the respondents may not directly benefit from this study, their involvement will help generate valuable insights. Upon request, a summary of the research findings will be shared with the respondents.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

The participants in this study will be from the Bachelor of Secondary Education program, majoring in Technical-Vocational Education, Physical Education, English, and Science, from the cohort 2020-2024. The researcher included or excluded respondents based on factors such as personal opinion, ethnicity, and socioeconomic status, but only when these were relevant to the

research question. This approach ensures fairness and relevance by including only those who are suited to the study's objectives, producing meaningful results applicable to the targeted group.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Data collection and analysis will be carried out using standardized procedures to ensure accurate and reliable results. All outputs will be carefully reviewed to reduce errors or biases. The study will also acknowledge limitations, such as sample size or potential biases, to maintain the integrity of the research and comply with all relevant guidelines on participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights. Additionally, all AI-generated content and outputs will be thoroughly reviewed to minimize errors and maintain objectivity, supporting the overall integrity of the research.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The results of this study will be reported accurately and truthfully, without altering or distorting the data. The researcher will acknowledge the importance of transparency and openly disclose any potential conflicts of interest that could affect the study. All third-party materials will be accurately cited to maintain openness and uphold intellectual property rights. This commitment to integrity will safeguard the validity of our research and foster trust in our findings.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

This study will utilize different resources, including copyrighted academic works and secondary data. The researchers recognize the importance of respecting intellectual property rights and obtaining all necessary permissions before using any copyrighted materials. All resources will be carefully cited in the final report to ensure proper attribution and transparency.

This commitment to ethical sourcing will uphold the integrity of the study and acknowledge the contributions of the original author, whose work supports this study.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

In this study, all respondents in human trials will receive an informed consent form that clearly explains the study's purpose, procedures, and potential risks and benefits. The informed consent process will emphasize that participation is entirely voluntary, informing respondents of their right to withdraw at any time without consequences. This approach ensures compliance with ethical standards outlined in relevant institutional and international guidelines for human subject research, thereby prioritizing the safety, dignity, and autonomy of all participants.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Technologies

The study will utilize Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools to uncover insights, adhering to responsible AI practices to ensure reliability and trustworthiness. ChatGPT will be utilized during early analysis, while Grammarly and Quillbot will enhance the manuscript's clarity and grammar, ensuring error-free presentation.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

This study will receive ethical approval from the Saint Michael College of Caraga Institutional Review Board, ensuring compliance with the highest standards for participant safety, data confidentiality, and intellectual property protection.

2.6. Data Gathering Procedure

In conducting this study, the researchers will follow a systematic process to gather the data necessary to achieve the research objectives. First, the researchers will seek approval from the

Dean of the College of Teacher Education at Saint Michael College of Caraga through a written letter requesting permission to conduct the study entitled, "A Contact Tracer Study of BSED Alumni Graduates of Saint Michael College of Caraga", and stating clearly the primary purpose of the study. Approval from the Dean of the College of Teacher Education is vital for this study, as the respondents are BSED graduates from the 2020-2024 batches at Saint Michael College of Caraga. Second, the researcher requests a letter to the registrar's office to access information about BSED graduates. They will submit a formal request letter to obtain the list of graduates from the Bachelor of Secondary Education program, majoring in Technical-Vocational Education, Physical Education, English, and Science. Lastly, the researchers will obtain informed consent from the respondents, ensuring that they are voluntarily participating. The researcher will utilize social media platforms, such as Messenger, to contact the respondents.

Letter of Approval. The researchers seek approval from the Dean of the College of Teacher Education to conduct the study. They also write a request letter to the office of the registrar to access profiles of BSED graduates from the 2020-2024 cohorts, including names, courses, and geographical locations.

Distribution of the Questionnaire. The researcher will utilize the Messenger platform, with access facilitated by the research adviser, to contact the graduates. The researchers will message respondents individually or through their group chat, and they will email a letter with the attached survey via Google Forms. The survey will be available for fifteen (15) days, with the possibility of extending the period by an additional three (3) days.

Informed Consent. Before conducting the study, the researchers will inform the respondents about the study's process and obtain their permission, ensuring that participation is voluntary.

Confidentiality. The researchers will take measures to ensure the confidentiality of participants' responses.

Gathering of Data. The researchers will gather, check, assess, tally, present, and interpret the collected data using statistical tools, guided by the research statistician.

Research Instrument

Saint Michael College of Caraga
Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines
Tel. Nos. +63 085 343-3251 / +63 085 283-3113
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

Part I. Demographic Profile
Directions: Please read each item and mark (/) the box that matches your condition.

Name (Optional): _____
Address: _____

Educational background:
( ) Bachelor of Secondary Education Major in Technical-Vocational Teacher Education
( ) Bachelor of Secondary Education Major in Physical Education
( ) Bachelor of Secondary Education Major in English
( ) Bachelor of Secondary Education Major in Science

Year Graduated:
( ) 2020
( ) 2021
( ) 2022
( ) 2023
( ) 2024

I. Graduates' Profile
Sex
( ) Male
( ) Female

Eligibility
( ) Licensure Examination
( ) Civil Service
( ) None

Highest Educational Attainment
( ) Bachelor's Degree
( ) Master's Degree (with units)
( ) Master's Degree (graduates)
( ) Doctor's Degree (with units)
( ) Doctor's Degree (graduates)

Employment status
( ) Employed
( ) Unemployed

Employment sector
( ) Private ____
( ) Public/Government ____
( ) NGO's ____
( ) Self-Employed ____
( ) Others, please specify, ____

Employment Category
( ) Regular/payment
( ) Contract of service
( ) Project employment/Job order
( ) Seasonal employment
( ) Underemployment

Monthly Income
( ) Below ₱5,000.00
( ) Between ₱6,000.00 to ₱10,000.00
( ) Between ₱10,000.00 to ₱20,000.00
( ) Between ₱20,000.00 to ₱30,000.00
( ) Between ₱30,000.00 to ₱40,000.00
( ) Between ₱40,000.00 to ₱50,000.00
( ) Between ₱50,000.00 to ₱60,000.00
( ) Between ₱60,000.00 and above

Nature of Work
( ) Education/Instructor/Teacher/ (Fahad A. Salendab*, Yolanda C. Dapitan)
( ) Health & Social Worker (*Angelique Rosarie P. Kaamiño, Dr. Rodelio B. Pasion**)***
( ) Call Center Agent (Rahmia M. Meto)
( ) Military (Rahmia M. Meto)
( ) Police (Rhami M. Meto)
( ) Cashier (Rhamia M. Meto)
( ) Clerical Support Worker (Rhamia M. Meto)
( ) Laborer/Construction Worker (*Angelique Rosarie P. Kaamiño, Dr. Rodelio B. Pasion)*
( ) Manufacturing (*Angelique Rosarie P. Kaamiño, Dr. Rodelio B. Pasion)*
( ) Service workers and shop and market sales workers (Duane Biscante, Dindo S)
( ) Farmers, forestry workers and fishermen (Duane Biscante, Dindo S)
( ) Mining and Quarrying (Bacani, Mary Rhovian B)
( ) Real State, Renting and Business Activites (Bacani, Mary Rhovian B)
( ) Others, please specify _____

Place of Work
( ) Butuan
( ) Buenavista
( ) Carmen
( ) Nasipit
( ) Cagayan de Oro City
( ) Siargao
( ) Surigao
( ) Abroad
( ) Others, please specify, _____.

Trainings Attended
( ) Seminars/Webinars
( ) Teaching Methodology Training
( ) First-aid Training
( ) Leadership and Supervision Training
( ) Special Education Training
( ) Technical Certification/National Certification
( ) Computer Literacy Training
( ) ICT Training
( ) Action and Basic Research Training
( ) ICT Training

Unemployed
Reasons for unemployment
( ) No job opportunity (*Apostol, M. Julie Mae,)*
( ) Lack of work experience (*Angelique Rosarie P. Kaamiño, Dr. Rodelio B. Pasion)*
( ) Prepare to take the licensure exam (Fahad A. Salendab*, Yolanda C. Dapitan)
( ) Waiting for a permanent position (Fahad A. Salendab*, Yolanda C. Dapitan)
( ) Unmotivated (Fahad A. Salendab*, Yolanda C. Dapitan)
( ) Did not look for a job (*Angelique Rosarie P. Kaamiño, Dr. Rodelio B. Pasion)*
( ) Soft skills deficiency (Fahad A. Salendab*, Yolanda C. Dapitan)
( ) Advance or further study (*Angelique Rosarie P. Kaamiño, Dr. Rodelio B. Pasion)*
( ) Health Concern (*Apostol, M. Julie Mae,)*

How long have you been unemployed.
( ) A few days or weeks
( ) A few months
( ) Several years

Part II. EMPLOYABILITY SKILLS

For each statement, please check (/) the choice that indicates the extent to which you learned the following with the statement using the following rating scale:

Rating Scale	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
4	Strongly Agree (SA)	I fully learned the skill indicated by SMCC.
3	Agree (A)	I moderately learned most of the skills indicated by SMCC.
2	Disagree (D)	I slightly learned the skill indicated by SMCC**.**
1	Strongly Disagree (SD)	I did not learn the skill indicated by SMCC.

Basic Skills in terms of Communication Skills	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I can express my ideas and information in verbal communication (e.g., meetings, presentations, job interviews). (Wu, Xu, & Philbin, 2023)				
2. I listen actively and respond to others in ways that ensure mutual understanding in team/work settings. (Ong et al., 2022).				
3. I can adapt my role in the work as needed to help the organization meet its objectives. (Mainga et al., 2022)				
4. I admit when I have made a mistake at work and take steps to correct it. (Majid, Sharil, & Salmee, 2022).				
5. I can coordinate work and responsibilities with team members to ensure deadlines and goals are met efficiently. (Bedoya-Guerrero et al., 2024)				
Thinking skills in terms of Critical Thinking	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I can analyze different solutions and strategies to make informed decisions on a problem. (Cacho et al., 2022)				

2. I apply creative approaches when solving problems or improving processes at work. (Indrašienė et al., 2023)				
3. I can assess situations, identify root problems, and evaluate effective solutions. (López et al. 2023)				
4. I organize information and work processes efficiently to achieve objectives. (Sebastião et al., 2023)				
5. I can anticipate potential risks and challenges when making work-related decisions. (Mat Saat et al., 2023)				
Thinking skills in terms of Creativity	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I adapt to changes at work and generate creative ideas that support organizational goals. (Zhao, Li, & Zhang, 2022)				
2. I can generate creative ideas to make effective decisions. (Ma, Zhang, & Dai, 2021)				
3. I can create innovative ideas to improve work processes or solve problems. (Setyaningrum & Muafi, 2022)				
4. I think outside the box to address workplace challenges. (OECD, 2025)				
5. I critically evaluate ideas before implementing them in my work. (Indrašienė et al., 2023)				
Personal Quality Skills in terms of Resilience	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I do not give up when I encounter setbacks at work. (Breevaart & van Woerkom, 2024)				
2. I enthusiastically take on challenging tasks at work. (Cai, Wang & Cheng, 2024).				
3. I can maintain cooperation with colleagues even during challenging situations. (Singh et al., 2024)				
4. I respect cultural differences and collaborate effectively with colleagues from				

diverse backgrounds. (Khan, Malik & Ali, 2024)				
5. I understand people's opinions and express empathy towards them. (Vallette d'Osia & Meier, 2024)				
Personal Quality Skills in terms of Initiative	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I proactively collaborate with colleagues to achieve team objectives and improve work outcomes. (Xia et al., 2020)				
2. I demonstrate respect and honesty to my colleagues to build trust and maintain a positive work environment. (Defeng Liu et al., 2022)				
3. I take initiative to start tasks, make timely decisions, and find effective solutions to workplace problems. (Kagan et al., 2021)				
4. I actively seek opportunities to develop myself and contribute to achieving work objectives. (Zhao, 2022)				
5. I demonstrate leadership and initiative to achieve organizational goals (Ismail et al., 2023)				
Personal Quality Skills in terms of Flexibility	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I adapt quickly to new tasks or responsibilities at work. (Zhao, Li, & Zhang, 2022)				
2. I collaborate flexibly with coworkers and leaders of diverse backgrounds. (Obodozie & Nwabufo, 2025)				
3. I can maintain good relationships even when workplace conditions become challenging. (Paredes-Saavedra et al., 2024)				
4. I can manage my emotions effectively during stressful work situations. (Madrid, Barros, & Vásquez, 2020)				
5. I think about how I communicate and how it affects others. (Wahid, Halim, & Halim, 2024)				

Resource and Capabilities Skills in terms of Productivity	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I effectively apply tools, technology, and materials to achieve organizational goals. (D'Oria et al., 2021)				
2. I can assess what resources and capabilities are needed to achieve organizational goals. (Ragadu & Rothmann 2025)				
3. I effectively collaborate with colleagues by sharing resources and skills to complete task. (Ragadu & Rothmann 2025)				
4. I can adapt to the job needs and contribute to achieving organizational goals. (Holidi & Seman 2023)				
5. I set achievable personal work goals using resources to achieve organizational objectives. (Ragadu & Rothmann 2025)				
Interpersonal Skills in terms of Collaboration	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I can inspire others and cooperatively work in groups toward a common goal. (Hoedemakers et al., 2023)				
2. I can maintain cooperative and supportive relationships with my colleagues to enhance team performance. (De Prada et al., 2022)				
3. I can provide constructive feedback and listen to others to enhance organizational productivity. (Aguenza & Ingles, 2024)				
4. I maintain positive relationships with my coworkers to achieve goals. (Mohamed et al., 2024)				
5. I respond appropriately and effectively to my coworkers. (Wijayanti, 2021)				
Interpersonal Skills in terms of Leadership	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I demonstrate leadership and influence within the organization, motivating others and contributing positively to an				

organization's goals. (Khan et al., 2020)				
2. I can present my idea to the organization with confidence and clarity. (Bhattacharyy & NtowOfei, 2020)				
3. I am empathetic and understanding towards the needs and perspectives of others. (Lekshmy et al., 2025)				
4. I can manage colleagues toward shared goals by building trust and respect. (Eva et al., 2024)				
5. I act honestly and ethically to set a positive example and help my team achieve goals. (Chandhok, 2021)				
Interpersonal Skills in terms of Negotiation Skills	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I manage conflicts effectively by negotiating fair solutions with colleagues and stakeholders. (Aggrawal & Magana, 2024)				
2. I can communicate clearly and work effectively with colleagues to achieve common goals. (Aruna, 2025)				
3. I can negotiate with colleagues to find positive solutions to workplace problems. (Tes, 2025)				
4. I create a positive work environment and successful client interaction. (Malokani et al., 2023)				
5. I can interact and connect with my colleagues with sensitivity, empathy, mentoring, and humor to work effectively and achieve goals. (Al Asefer & Zainal Abidin, 2021)				
Interpersonal Skills in terms of Social Skills	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I can collaborate effectively with people through digital platforms and online meetings. (Đorđević et al., 2025)				
2. I communicate my ideas clearly and appropriately in different social and				

professional situations. (Duvvuri et al., 2024)				
3. I can establish positive working relationships with colleagues and supervisors. (Mohamed et al., 2024)				
4. I provide constructive and positive feedback to my coworkers to support teamwork and achieve organizational goals. (Kalistratova, 2024)				
5. I provide guidance and direction to others to support team and organizational success. (Malokani et al., 2023)				
Interpersonal Skills in terms of Intercultural Skills	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I can work effectively and enjoy collaborating with colleagues from diverse backgrounds. (Ahmed, 2024)				
2. I communicate effectively with people from different cultural backgrounds. (Schislyaeva & Saychenko, 2022)				
3. I respect my coworkers' cultures and beliefs. (Schultz, 2022)				
4. I can motivate and collaborate with diverse colleagues to achieve team goals. (Mohamad et al., 2024)				
5. I can adapt my behavior and approach when working with people from different cultural backgrounds. (Sierra-Huedo & Foucart, 2022)				
Information Skills in terms of Information Literacy	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I can organize and utilize information effectively to support problem-solving and make informed decisions. (Widén et al., 2021)				
2. I can discern which information is valuable and reliable from a wide range of sources to contribute to organizational success. (Naveed et al., 2022)				

3. I can critically select, combine, and organize information to draw a meaningful conclusion. (Huang & Ye, 2022)				
4. I use information ethically, respecting intellectual property and privacy. (Shaukat et al., 2024)				
5. I can communicate information clearly and effectively using appropriate tools or platforms. (Tee et al., 2024)				
Information Skills in terms of Media Literacy	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I can evaluate misinformation, bias, or fake news in media sources. (Naveed et al., 2022)				
2. I use media responsibly to support professional communication and collaboration. (Nikou et al., 2022)				
3. I can collaborate with colleagues using online tools to achieve work objectives. (Kitanovikj & Kitanovikj, 2023)				
4. I critically evaluate online information for accuracy, credibility, and relevance to achieve work goals. (Caroline et al., 2024)				
5. I am confident in my ability to interpret information presented in various media formats to support work tasks and decisions. (Kodrat et al., 2024)				
System Technological Skills in terms of Technical Literacy	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I efficiently use and manage a variety of digital tools and technologies to complete work tasks successfully. (Tee et al., 2024)				
2. I leverage technological tools to enhance productivity and achieve organizational goals. (Zuñiga-Collazos et al., 2025)				
3. I can effectively manage and solve basic technical problems. (Suleman et al., 2022)				

4. I know how to use technology to identify solutions to work-related problems. (Abdul Hamid, 2022)				
5. I confidently learn and adapt to new technologies and systems to improve work performance. (Do, 2024)				

CHAPTER 3

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

4.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data

Research Question 1

Research Question 2

Research Question 3

4.2 Proposed Intervention/ Output

DELETE BOX AFTER READING

Check the guidelines in research writing.

Make sure to integrate Mendeley in the citation.

Use Calibri 11 and double space

Begin Presentation of Data by Research Question. Make it BOLD and the discussion normal letters. Example:

1. **What is the profile of the respondents in terms of:**
   - **1.1 Age**
   - **1.2 Sex**
   - **1.3 Monthly Income**

CHAPTER 4

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION, RECOMMENDATION,

5.1. Summary

5.2. Conclusion

5.3.Recommendation

DELETE BOX AFTER READING

Check the guidelines in research writing.

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ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

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Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

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Tertiary	:	Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

APPENDICES

A - Letter of Approval with Certificate of Appearance and Photo
B - Instrument with Informed Consent
C - Map of the Research Locale *(Include Coordinates)*
D - Narrative & Photo Documentation
E- Ethics Committee Approval

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